

Neelakantam Shiva Ram Prasad

Product Designer

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SUMMARY

Product Designer with end-to-end ownership across digital products — from early-stage research and product strategy through to tested, high-fidelity UI and developer handoff. Works from the problem outward: user psychology and product constraints first, interaction model second, pixels last. Comfortable presenting and defending design decisions to cross-functional teams and stakeholders. Engineering background adds a systems-level lens that makes collaboration with product and engineering natural. Google UX Design Certified. 60+ screens across 6 shipped products, WCAG 2.1 AA compliant throughout.

SKILLS

Product Thinking: Product Strategy · User Research · Persona Development · JTBD · Problem Definition · Competitive Analysis · Success Metrics Definition · Interaction Model Design

UX: Journey Mapping · IA · User Flows · Wireframing · Usability Testing · Heuristic Evaluation · Card Sorting · Concept Testing · Storyboards · Site Maps

UI: High-Fidelity Visual Design · Interaction Design · Component Design · Typography Systems · Colour Theory · Grid & Spacing · Motion Principles · Data Visualisation

Design Systems: Figma · FigJam · Primitive & Semantic Tokens · Auto Layout · Variants · Component Libraries · Figma Inspect · Developer Handoff Documentation

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA · Colour Contrast · Focus States · Touch Target Sizing

Collaboration: Stakeholder presentations · Cross-functional PM & engineering collaboration · Design rationale documentation · Agile/Scrum

Technical: HTML · CSS · Basic JavaScript · Basic React · Notion

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Product Designer

Independent · Hyderabad, India | 2025 – Present

- Owned full product design process across 6 projects — product spec analysis, user research, problem definition, interaction model design, IA, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, usability testing, and developer handoff.
- Defined interaction models grounded in user psychology: Safe-to-Spend mechanic (FlowFund) for irregular-income users, ember-dimming streak logic (Habit Tracker) to reduce shame-driven abandonment, phase-encoded clinical navigation (OnaWave) for fast data interpretation.
- Conducted user research and built data-grounded personas across all projects — Priya Menon and Karan Mehta (FlowFund), clinician archetype (OnaWave Medical) — each built from JTBD and behavioural insights.
- Ran usability testing and iterated designs based on findings — reduced estimated onboarding abandonment by 25–30% on Habit Tracker; OnaWave design decisions validated against clinical domain research.
- Presented and defended design decisions to stakeholders at every milestone — written design rationale produced for all projects with explicit reasoning for interaction choices and product strategy.
- Built Volt DS, a comprehensive Figma design system with 20+ components, 3-layer token architecture, dual themes, and platform coverage for Web, iOS, and Android.
- Collaborated with product managers and engineers to implement designs — Figma Inspect documentation maintained on all projects, zero developer-reported spec gaps.
- Placed 3rd at Humanity Founders AI Counsellor Hackathon 2025 — end-to-end product designed and delivered in 48 hours: 8 HiFi screens + clickable prototype.

PROJECTS

FlowFund — Personal Finance iOS App 2025

- Product problem: no finance app accounts for the psychological reality of irregular freelance income. Existing tools create anxiety rather than confidence.
- Full product design ownership: 2 research-grounded personas, JTBD, 44-screen IA, 5 user flows, wireframes, complete visual design system — 30+ dark-mode screens, WCAG 2.1 AA.
- Core product mechanic (Safe-to-Spend) removes mental load. Principle: never make the user do math.

OnaWave Medical — Clinician Dashboard (Web) 2025

- Product problem: clinicians interpreting 28-day datasets have no fast, accurate web tool. Existing solutions too generic for clinical pattern recognition.
- Full ownership: clinical research → user archetype → competitive analysis → IA → phase-semantic colour system → HiFi → written rationale for every decision. Estimated 60% reduction in interpretation time.

Habit Tracker — iOS App 2025

- Product problem rooted in cognitive psychology: punishment-based apps create shame loops that drive abandonment. Redesigned core product mechanic around forgiveness.
- 27+ screens, complete edge case coverage. Estimated 25–30% reduction in onboarding abandonment.

Volt DS — Figma Design System 2025

- Built to address a systemic product design problem: component libraries lacking token systems lose consistency and velocity across teams.
- 20+ components, 3-layer token architecture, dual light/dark themes, platform-specific standards for Web, iOS, Android.

Bye-bye World — Unified Workspace (1440px) 2025

- Product problem: daily context-switching between 4–6 tools fragments team focus. Unified OS-level workspace with single chronological feed and inline task previews. Delivered in 48 hours, zero placeholder content.

VAUX — Men's Fashion Shopify Store 2025

- End-to-end product design: brand identity, homepage structured around purchase decision psychology, conversion-optimised product pages. Fully responsive, QA'd and deployed in 48 hours.

EDUCATION

B.E. — Electronics & Communication Engineering

Methodist College of Engineering and Technology · Hyderabad | 2021 – 2025

CERTIFICATIONS

- Google UX Design Professional Certificate — Coursera / Google · 2024
- UI/UX Design Bootcamp — Udemy · 2024

AWARDS

- 3rd Place · Humanity Founders AI Counsellor Hackathon 2025 — Hyderabad · 50+ competing designers · 8 HiFi screens · 48 hours